FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of October 4–10, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Proverbs 22:6

"Train up a child in the way he should go; even when he is old he will not depart from it."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Deuteronomy 4:21–40; Matthew 8:1–17
Mon: Deuteronomy 5:1–21; Matthew 8:18–34
Tue: Deuteronomy 5:22—6:9; Matthew 9:1–17
Wed: Deuteronomy 6:10–25; Matthew 9:18–38
Thu: Deuteronomy 7:1–19; Matthew 10:1–23
Fri: Deuteronomy 8:1–20; Matthew 10:24–42
Sat: Deuteronomy 9:1–22; Matthew 11:1–19

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Christ Is Made the Sure Foundation" — LSB 909

Christ is made the sure foundation, / Christ, the head and cornerstone, / Chosen of the Lord and precious, / Binding all the Church in one; / Holy Zion's help forever / And her confidence alone.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Nineteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 22) October 4, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 118:22–24; antiphon: v. 1*

Oh give thanks to the LORD, for he is good;
for his steadfast love endures forever!
The stone that the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone.
This is the LORD's doing;
it is marvelous in our eyes.
This is the day that the LORD has made;
let us rejoice and be glad in it.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Oh give thanks to the LORD, for he is good;
for his steadfast love endures forever!

Collect of the Day

To be added from the Sunday service folder.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 5:1–7 · Psalm 80:7–19 · Philippians 3:4b–14 · Matthew 21:33–46

Gradual *Psalm 91:11; 103:1*

For he will command his angels concerning you
to guard you in all your ways.
Bless the LORD, O my soul,
and all that is within me, bless his holy name!

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 23)

Isaiah 25:6–9 · Psalm 23 · Philippians 4:4–13 · Matthew 22:1–14

Learn by Heart: The Ninth Commandment *LSB p. 322*

"You shall not covet your neighbor's house. What does this mean? We should fear and love God so that we do not scheme to get our neighbor's inheritance or house, or get it in a way which only appears right, but help and be of service to him in keeping it."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: Isaiah sings a love song about a vineyard that produced only wild grapes, and Jesus picks it straight up: tenants who beat the servants, kill the son, and imagine the vineyard will be theirs. Then He quotes Psalm 118 — the stone the builders threw away is the cornerstone. This week Deuteronomy gives the Ten Commandments and the Shema, and Matthew fills up with healings. Ask one another: "What has God entrusted to our family that we treat as if we owned it outright?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "altar"?

The altar is the large, table-like object at the center front of the sanctuary. The word comes from the Latin altare, meaning "a place for offering sacrifices." On top of many altars are five carved crosses — one for each of the five wounds of Christ.

Those five crosses mark the altar as a place where no more blood sacrifices will ever happen. The only sacrifice needed was made on the cross. The altar is now a place where Christ gives out the forgiveness He earned. This week's Gospel calls Him the cornerstone the builders threw away — the stone everything else is built on.

Parents: *During the service, direct your children's attention to the altar and point out that this is where God has promised to come to be with us. Afterward, take them up to look, reminding them to be reverent in God's holy place.*

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